OPF

CREATIVITY FOR HUMANITY

The 2026 Ogun Poetry Festival

SCHOOL ENTRY BROCHURE

Saturday, December 5, 2026 · 10:00 AM – 3:00 PM · Cinema Hall, June 12 Cultural Centre, Abeokuta

2026 THEME

“Artistic Expression for Advocacy”

Prepared by
Ogun Poetry Festival — Executive Organizing Committee

Distributed to
Participating Junior & Senior Secondary Schools and Tertiary Institutions

01 · GETTING STARTED

Welcome to OPF 2026

The Ogun Poetry Festival channels poetry, performance, and creative writing into real youth advocacy and development. This brochure is for teachers, coordinators, and student representatives preparing an entry — it covers every competition category, delegation requirements, prizes, and key dates for the 2026 edition.

20	20	Dec 5
Secondary Schools (10 public / 10 private)	Students per School Delegation	Festival Day 2026

2026 PROGRAM FOCUS

This edition uses poetry, performance art, and creative writing as practical instruments for youth mental wellness, health advocacy, civic engagement, and the creative economy — turning the stage into a channel for real behavioural and social change across Ogun State's schools and communities. Alongside the writing and performance categories, students are introduced to digital literacy and AI-assisted storytelling tools as a practical, employable skill layer.

WHO THIS BROCHURE IS FOR

- **Junior Secondary coordinators** — entering written poetry submissions
- **Senior Secondary coordinators** — entering a themed video submission
- **Tertiary institution literary/poetry clubs and student associations** — entering the live Slam

> **A note on evaluation**
> All Junior Secondary written entries and Senior Secondary video entries are pre-screened and scored by the judging panel **before** festival day. Results are kept confidential and announced live at the event.

Junior Secondary Category

Theme	Health & Mental Well-being
Format	Written poetry submission
Representatives	Maximum 2 student writers per school
Evaluation	Pre-screened and scored by the academic review board before event day; results confidential until the festival

AWARDS

— Cash prizes for 1st, 2nd, and 3rd place (fully secured sponsorship)

— 5 educational game packs distributed to the top 5 schools

— Academic awards, educational hampers, and certificates for top 3 students

SUBMISSION GUIDANCE

— Poems should respond to the Health & Mental Well-being theme in the student's own words and experience

— Submit both student entries together as your school's official Junior Secondary entry

— Selected entries may be developed into an AI-illustrated visual piece as part of the winning experience

> **Why this theme**
>
> Health & Mental Well-being gives younger students an early, age-appropriate introduction to using writing as a voice for things that are often left unsaid — before they move into the more advanced advocacy work expected at Senior Secondary level.

02 · COMPETITION CATEGORIES

Senior Secondary Category

Theme	Health Advocacy — e.g. counterfeit drugs, adulterated food, public healthcare challenges
Format	1 pre-recorded video submission per school
Team size	Exactly 5 student performers per video
Style	Spoken word, theatrical performance, or protest style
Evaluation	Judges review and score submissions before the event; winners announced during the festival

AWARDS

— Top 3 placements receive awards

— 5 educational game packs go to the top 5 schools

VIDEO SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

— One video per school featuring exactly 5 senior students

— Video should be a themed advocacy piece — spoken word, theatrical, or protest-style performance

— Submit ahead of the judging window so the panel has sufficient time to score before early December

> **Production note**
> Strong entries treat the health issue as a real, specific advocacy target — not an abstract topic. Teams are encouraged to name the concrete problem their piece is speaking to.

02 · COMPETITION CATEGORIES

Tertiary Institutions Slam

Theme	Civic Engagement (voter participation, governance, accountability) **or** The Creative Economy
Format	Live stage performance only — no video submissions
Evaluation	Live judging panel on festival day
Registration fee	₦15,000 – ₦20,000 per institution

AWARDS

— 1st place: ₦90,000 cash prize + trophy

— 2nd place: ₦60,000 cash prize + plaque

— Awarded across 6 participating institutions

WHERE TO REACH STUDENTS ON CAMPUS

— Faculty student associations

— English and Arts departments

— University literary and poetry clubs

> **Choosing your theme**
>
> Each participating institution performs under **either** Civic Engagement **or** The Creative Economy — not both. Confirm your institution's theme with the OPF secretariat at the time of registration.

Delegation Size & Overview

Each of the 20 participating secondary schools (10 public, 10 private) brings an in-person delegation of **exactly 20 students** on festival day:

— **2 Junior Secondary writers** — written poetry category

— **5 Senior Secondary performers** — whose video entry is screened on the day

— **13 general student attendees** — participate in event-day workshops and interactive sessions

Category	Theme	Format	Prizes
Junior Secondary	Health & Mental Well-being	Written poetry (max 2 per school)	Cash 1st–3rd + 5 game packs
Senior Secondary	Health Advocacy	Video, team of 5 per school	Top 3 awarded + 5 game packs
Tertiary Slam	Civic Engagement or Creative Economy	Live performance	₦90,000 / ₦60,000

REGISTRATION, DUES & CERTIFICATION

— Participating institutions are enrolled through a structured registration process

— Schools and tertiary institutions receive official participation documentation

— Participating students, educators, and chaperones are eligible for certificates and formal commendation

> **Educator & chaperone recognition**
> OPF recognizes the critical role teachers and chaperones play in identifying talent, preparing students, and sustaining participation. Selected educators and chaperones receive formal commendation.

REGISTRATION FEES

— Secondary schools: ₦5,000 per school

— Tertiary institutions: ₦15,000 – ₦20,000 per institution (see page 5)

03 · DELEGATION & REGISTRATION

Key Dates & How to Register

SCHOOL REGISTRATION CLOSES MID-OCTOBER 2026 — confirm your delegation early to secure your school's place

September 2026	Formal school outreach and registration opens as schools resume
Mid-October 2026	All school entry confirmations and registrations close
October – Early Dec 2026	Junior written entries and Senior video uploads collected and scored by the judging panel
Saturday, Dec 5, 2026	Festival day — Cinema Hall, June 12 Cultural Centre, Abeokuta, 10:00 AM – 3:00 PM

HOW TO REGISTER YOUR SCHOOL

— Email the OPF Secretariat to confirm your school's participation and category entries

— Submit written and video entries ahead of the scoring deadline

— Confirm your full 20-student delegation before festival day

Secretariat	FCE Abeokuta
Email	ogunpoetryfestival@gmail.com / ogunpoetryfestivalmedia@gmail.com
Address	Abeokuta, Ogun State

> **Questions before you register?**
> Reach out to the Secretariat by email — the team can confirm category fit, delegation logistics, and submission formats ahead of the mid-October deadline.